



Days Matter as a Reminder System

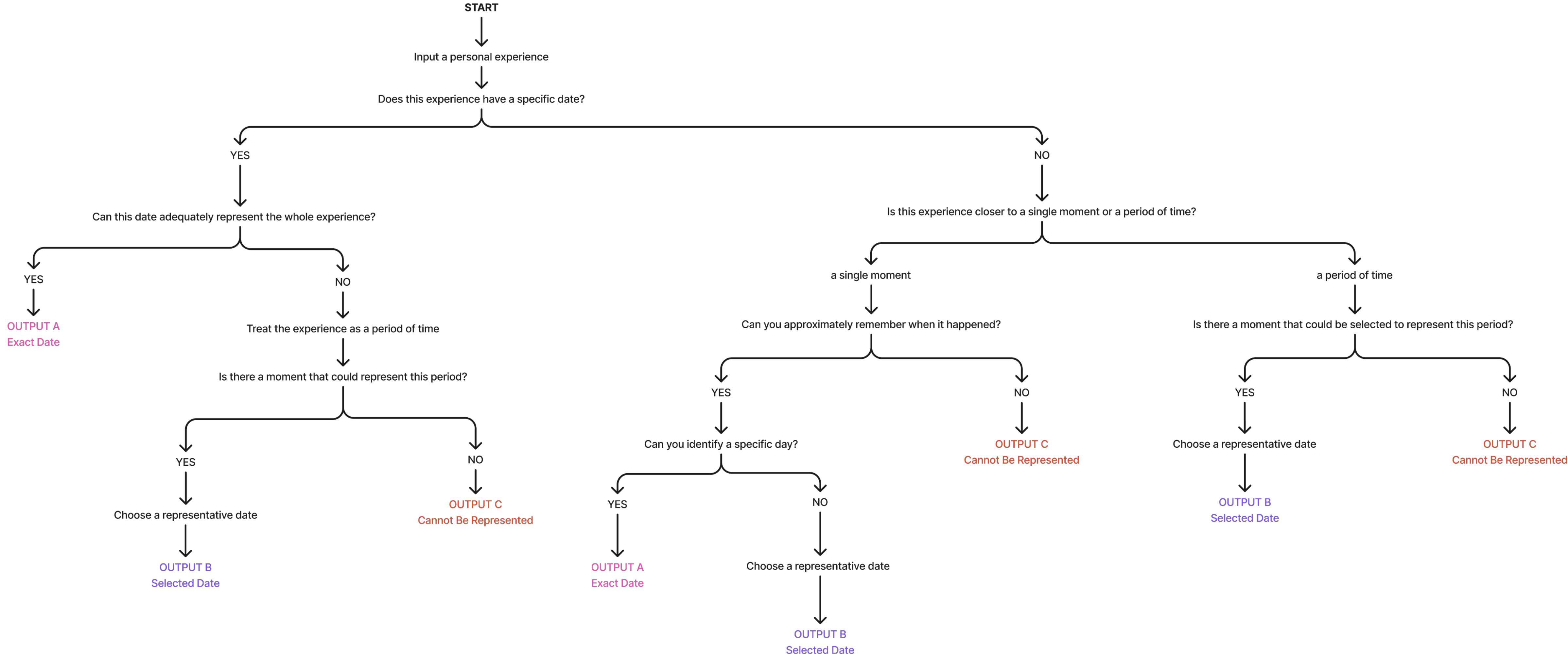
Reconstructing How Days Matter Turns Personal Experiences into Dates

Days Matter can only calculate an event after it has been represented as a specific date.
For this assignment, I focused on what happens before Days Matter starts counting. I reconstructed how a personal experience becomes a date the app can process.

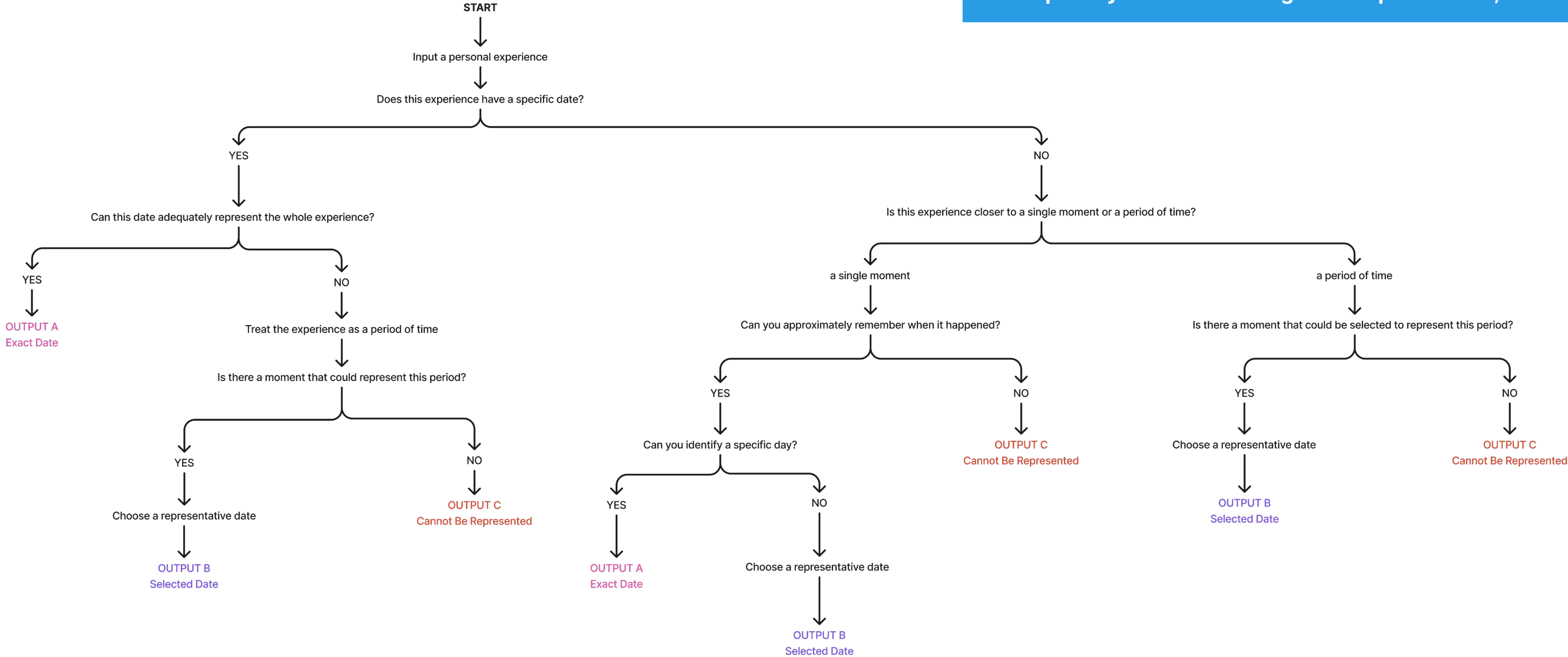
Input 1:
A specific event with an exact date
Example: My friend’s wedding is on September 13, 2026.

Input 2:
A single moment with an uncertain date
Example: I graduated in the summer of 2025.

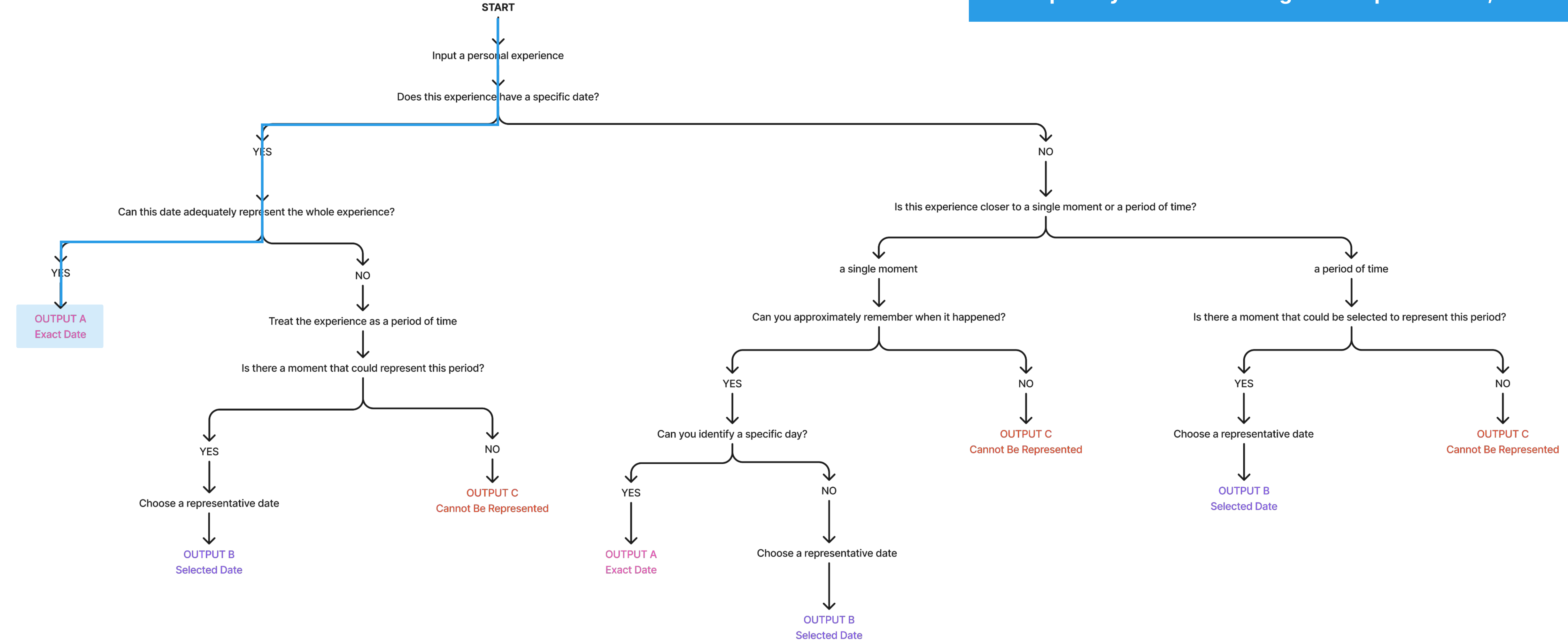
Input 3:
A gradual experience that cannot be represented by one specific date
Example: I gradually started to feel that New York was becoming home.



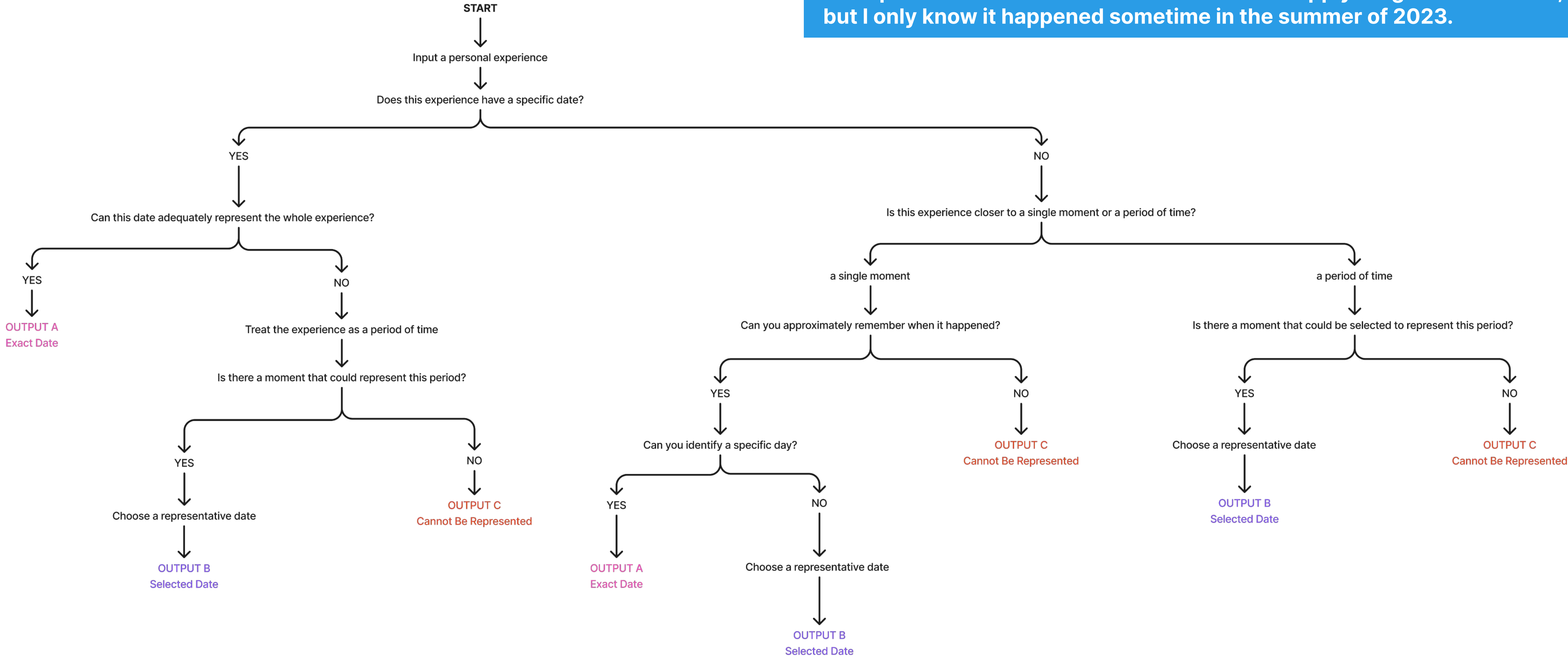
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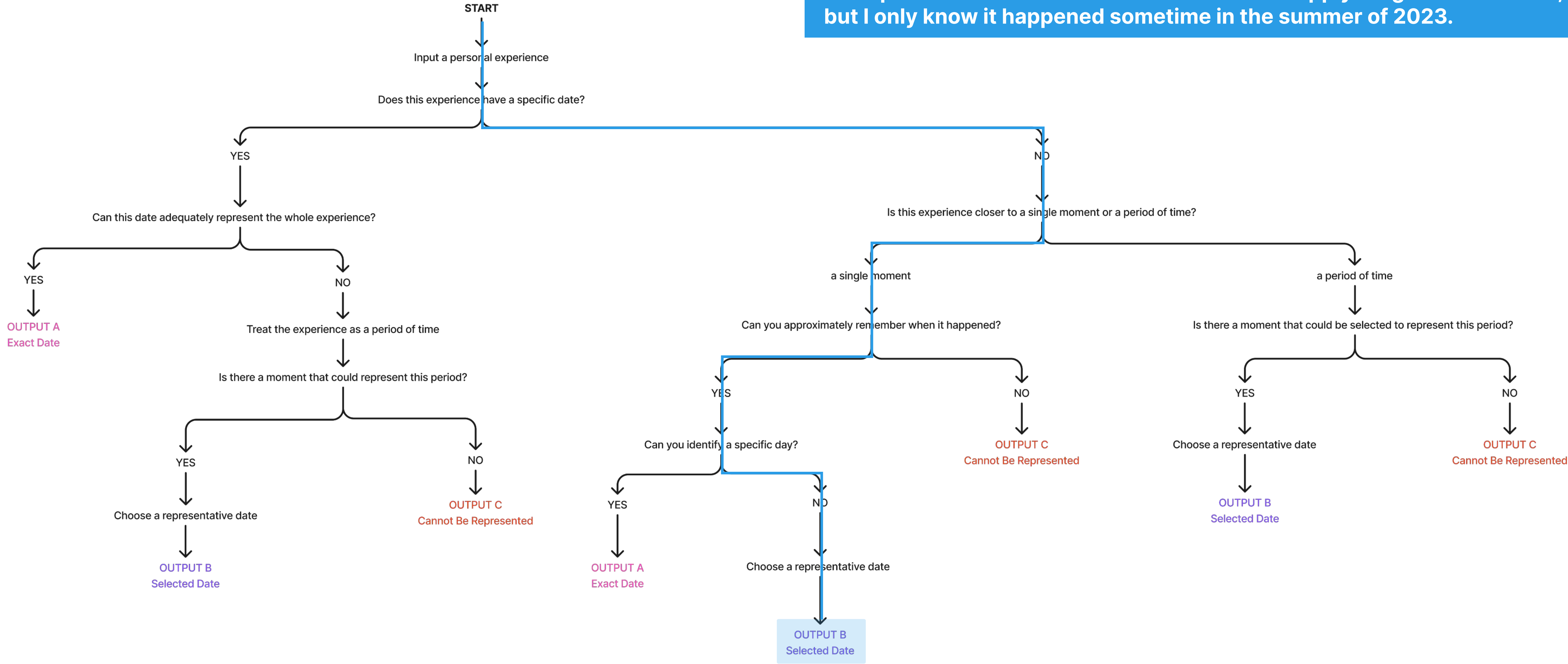
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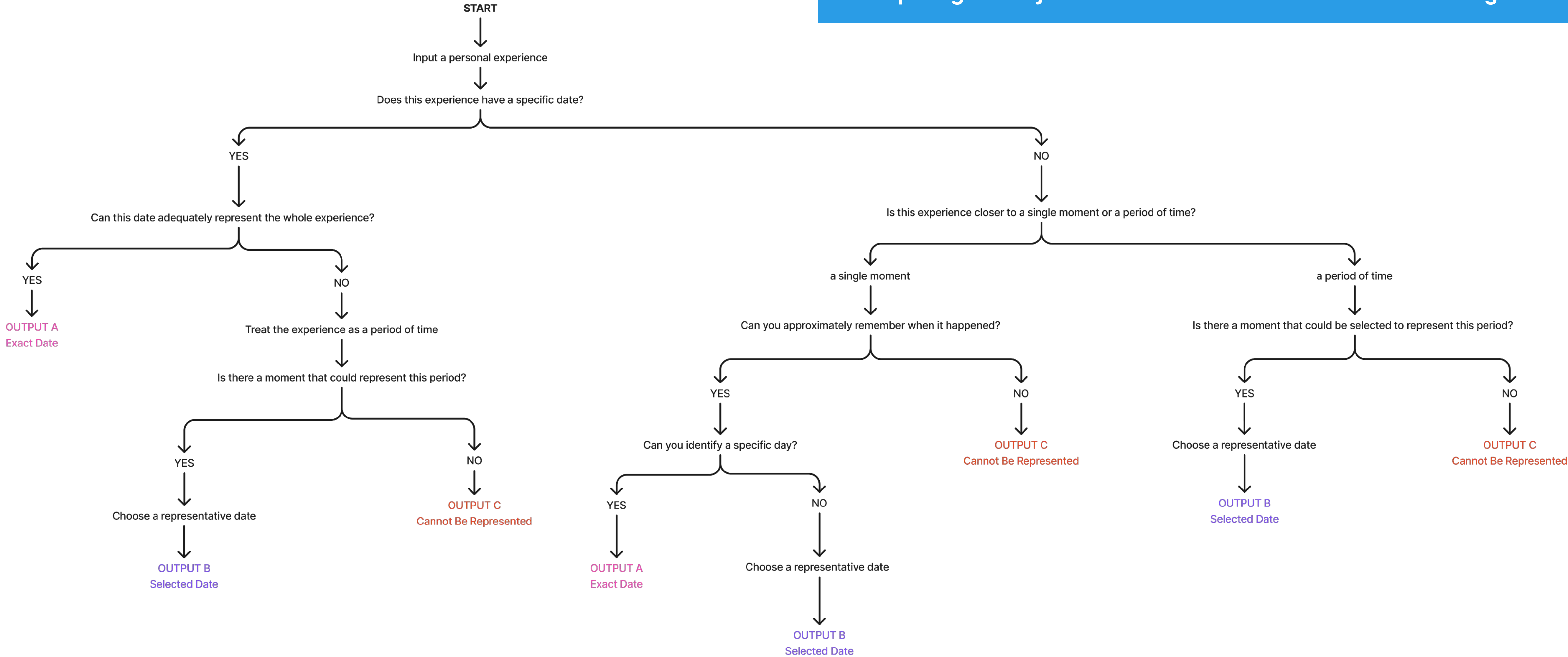
Input 2:
A single moment with an uncertain date
Example: I remember the moment I decided to apply for graduate school,
but I only know it happened sometime in the summer of 2023.



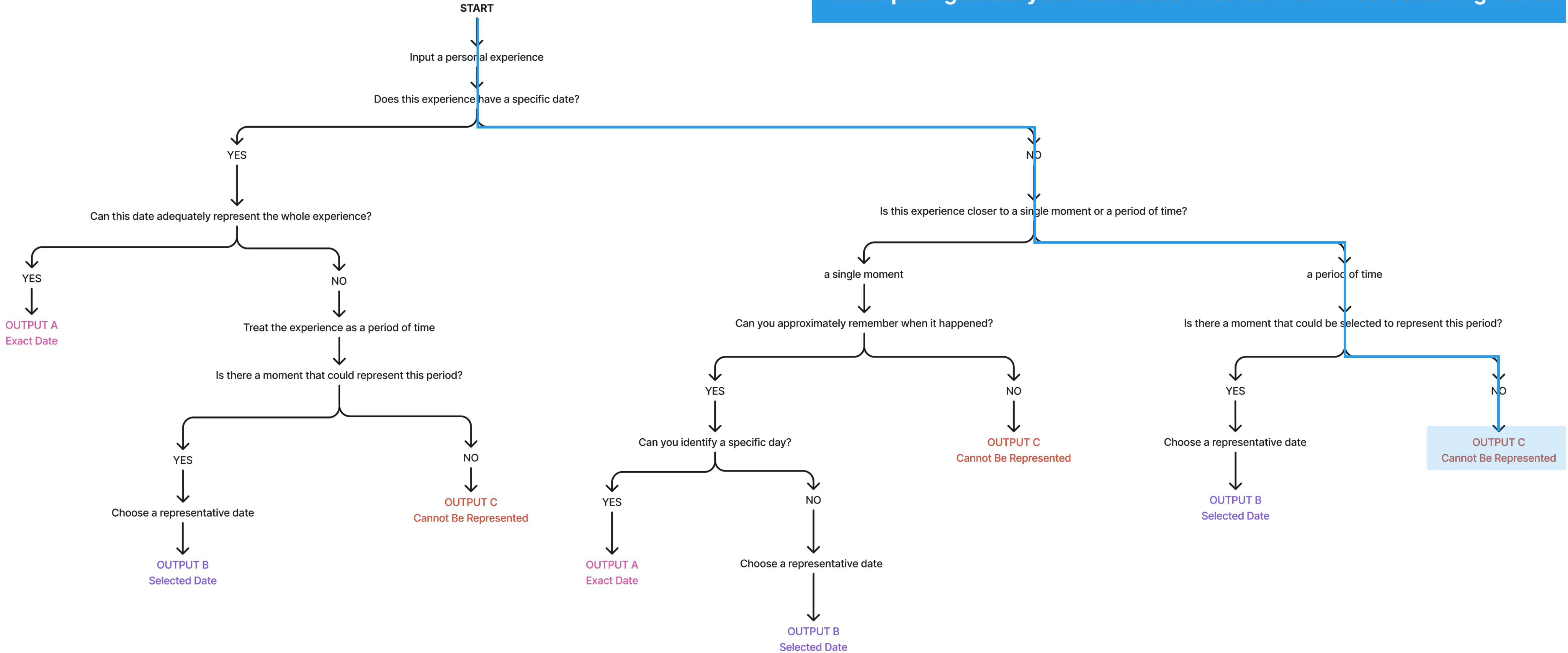
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**Output 1:
Exact Date**

**Output 2:
Selected Date**

**Output 3:
Cannot Be Represented**

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Observation:

- 1. The system favors experiences that can be tied to a clear, singular point in time.**
- 2. A period of experience has to be reduced to a representative date before the system can process it.**
- 3. A manually selected date can appear just as precise as an objectively known date.**
- 4. Some experiences cannot be represented by a single date and are therefore excluded by the system.**
- 5. The system does not understand the meaning of an experience. It only determines whether that experience can be formatted as a date.**

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Ambiguous case:

A gradual experience may have several equally plausible representative dates, so the system has to force one choice even when no single date is objectively correct.

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Further question:

What kinds of information must be made explicit before a system can act intelligently?